opening of the historic Stilwell Road that linked Assam, Myanmar and Kunming in Yunnan province of China during the Second World War. Only a small portion of about 150 kilometres needs to be made motorable from Pangsau Pass (which is connected on our side by a national highway) to Shingbwiyang. This road would connect Ledo, an important logistics base of Second World War fame in Assam, with Myitkina through the Pangsau Pass on the Arunachal Pradesh-Myanmar border, and on to the frontier area of Yunnan province of China, a distance of about 600 kilometres. (The original distance from Ledo to Kunming was 1760 kilometres.) This recommencement of formal border trade will truly give a boost to the economy of the northeastern states, particularly Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Nagaland and Meghalaya. As timber will be one of the major items of import, it would help in the revival of wood- and timber-based industries in the northeast. These had to be closed down following the Supreme Court's restrictions on timber operations in 1996. I have been making this point ever since I took charge as the governor. Since this subject concerns many ministries and agencies, the decision-making has been delayed. But I understand that it is still under consideration of the NSA. If media reports are to be believed, the Chinese have beaten us to it and might probably go ahead and complete this road upto Pangsau Pass from the Myanmar side.

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[1] http://www.southasiaanalysis.org/%5Cpapers37%5Cpaper3662.html